

Mustafa Ali Akbar

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mstf.work

11 September 2026

Visa Section

Consulate General of the Federal Republic of Germany

1330 Post Oak Boulevard, Suite 1850

Houston, Texas 77056

Application for an Opportunity Card

Dear Visa Officer,

I am applying for an Opportunity Card so I can conduct a focused, in-person search for a qualified product design or design engineering role in Germany. I recently completed a master's degree at The University of Texas at Austin, where I focused on human-computer interaction, after more than seven years of professional product design work.

Most of my experience has been with software that people rely on to do complicated work. At Educative, I joined as the sole designer for 30 developers, built the design team, and worked on learning and enterprise products used by millions of people. At Motive, I designed a remote vehicle immobilization experience, a driver identification hardware product, and fleet safety tools. I also build working front ends when the interaction is easier to test in code than in a static design file.

Germany appeals to me because much of the work I want to continue sits between software, engineering, and physical systems. I am especially interested in mobility, industrial and enterprise software, and learning technology. Earlier in my career, I designed GRID for Düsseldorf-based venues during the COVID closures. More recently, my fleet work made me want to keep designing products where software has to account for real operational constraints.

My search will focus on senior product designer, product designer, and design engineer positions. I will apply nationwide, with an initial focus on Berlin, Hamburg, Munich, and the Rhine-Ruhr region. I have a portfolio of shipped products and working prototypes, and I plan to use company career pages, professional networks, and direct outreach to hiring teams. Being in Germany would make it easier to meet teams and evaluate roles in the environment where the work happens.

After graduate school, I consulted for two AI startups on product design and frontend development. I built a workspace where traders work with AI agents, and a motion library to explain technical concepts at NextWork, an AI learning startup. I am now looking for a full-time role where I can take responsibility for a product and improve it over time.

I will support myself using the financial resources documented separately in my application and will maintain the required health insurance. I plan to arrange temporary accommodation in Germany while I look for work. I understand the purpose and conditions of the Opportunity Card and will comply with them.

Thank you for considering my application.

Sincerely,

Mustafa Ali Akbar

Mustafa Ali Akbar

Product Designer and Design Engineer

Austin, Texas | mustafa.ali.akbar96@gmail.com | +1 737 389 0364 | [Portfolio](#) | [LinkedIn](#) | [GitHub](#)

Professional Profile

Product designer with more than seven years of experience across enterprise software, fleet operations, education technology, 3D interfaces, and front-end implementation. Experienced in research, interaction design, design systems, and building working prototypes with modern web technologies.

Professional Experience

- | | |
|------------------------------|--|
| 07/2026 | Stealth Startup - Agentic Trading
<i>Design Engineer Consultant Austin, Texas</i> <ul style="list-style-type: none">Built a human-agent trading workspace for public launch with Next.js, TypeScript, Zustand, and TanStack Query.Advised the founding team on product direction, design, and marketing. |
| 06/2026 | NextWork
<i>Design Engineer Consultant Austin, Texas</i> <ul style="list-style-type: none">Built a motion library with the Canvas API and Three.js to explain technical concepts to learners. |
| 06/2025
- 08/2025 | CBRE
<i>UX Designer, Contract Richardson, Texas</i> <ul style="list-style-type: none">Designed and built SmartFM's 3D login experience across platforms with Three.js and Blender. |
| 09/2023
- 08/2024 | Motive
<i>Senior Product Designer Remote</i> <ul style="list-style-type: none">Designed the 0-to-1 remote vehicle immobilization experience for Motive's first third-party hardware product; the launch helped unlock more than \$8 million in annual recurring revenue in Latin America.Designed dashboard and assignment workflows for the Driver ID Reader hardware launch so exempt fleets could identify drivers.Built a fleet safety and maintenance product that saved more than \$500,000 annually for Motive's largest U.S. customer by fleet count. |
| 09/2020
- 09/2023 | Educative
<i>Design Lead III Pakistan</i> <ul style="list-style-type: none">Joined as the sole designer for 30 developers, then hired and led a team of 10 designers after the company's Series A.Designed core consumer learning products as Educative grew from 500,000 to 2.5 million users.Designed developer onboarding and engineering productivity products that closed a \$100,000 annual contract.Built, implemented, and maintained a design system used by product, marketing, and content teams across six B2B and B2C software products. |
| 12/2018
- 09/2020 | UXrally
<i>UX Designer Pakistan</i> <ul style="list-style-type: none">Designed GRID, a digital nightlife product for Düsseldorf-based venues during the COVID closures.Researched Trivago's position among competitors and redesigned the product around its role as a low-price hotel aggregator. |

Education

08/2024 - 04/2026	The University of Texas at Austin Austin, Texas <i>Master of Science in Information Studies, Human-Computer Interaction focus</i> Designed and built Capstone Matchmaker, a FERPA-compliant recruitment platform for five user groups across mobile and desktop. Shipped the working product in under two weeks.
09/2013 - 06/2017	Lahore Leads University Lahore, Pakistan <i>Bachelor of Science in Software Engineering</i>

Selected Independent Work

mstf.work	Designed and built a 3D portfolio with React Three Fiber and Blender to test spatial navigation and state changes.
3D Gradients Generator	Built a Three.js and GLSL tool that generates gradients from noise algorithms.
Capstone Matchmaker	Designed the product and built the front end, API routes, database schema, and cloud deployment with Next.js, PostgreSQL, AWS RDS, and EC2.

Skills

Product Design	User research, interaction design, information architecture, visual design, prototyping, design systems, accessibility, data visualization
Engineering	JavaScript, TypeScript, HTML/CSS, React, Next.js, Three.js, Zustand, TanStack Query, GSAP, PostgreSQL, AWS
Tools	Figma, Rive, Blender, Origami Studio, Axure RP, Framer, Adobe Creative Cloud, Jira, Linear, Notion
Platforms	Web, desktop, responsive mobile, operational dashboards, connected hardware, 3D interfaces
English	Professional and academic working language

Job Search Focus

Qualified roles in product design and design engineering, with an emphasis on mobility, industrial and enterprise software, and learning technology. Available for opportunities throughout Germany.

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